UNIFORMED GROUPS · LEADER PACK

Food Detectives

Unwrapped Education · in association with Unwrap

Two ready-to-run meeting plans about reading food labels. Hands-on games, cards and teamwork. No projector, no screens, no cooking and no tasting. Everything you need is in this pack.

Plan	Section	Length	Print from this pack
A · Label Detectives	Cubs (8–10½), older Beavers, Brownies	60 min	The Plan A pages: label cards, Kitchen or Factory? cards, Eatwell cards, Label Lab, Label Hunt
B · Behind the Label	Scouts (10½–14), Guides	60–75 min	The Plan B pages: loaf labels and E number key, Spectrum cards, Claim Court, Honest Pack

How it links to badges

- **Cubs Chef Activity Badge.** Requirement 3 asks Cubs to "learn what the major food groups are" and how they fit a healthy diet. Plan A includes an Eatwell Guide sort that covers this. It helps towards the badge; leaders decide when a requirement is met.
- **Scouts Chef Activity Badge.** Requirements 1 and 2 ask Scouts to plan a menu around the group's dietary needs and to show how and where to shop. Reading labels for allergens and ingredients supports both.
- Neither badge requires label reading. These plans are an extra, not a replacement for any requirement.

Ground rules for leaders

- No "good" or "bad" foods, and no talk about weight or bodies. We're finding out how food is made, not judging anyone's lunchbox.
- All labels are made up. No real brands are named.
- No food is handled. If you add real packets, use clean, empty ones and check your section's allergy list.
- Nothing here asks young people to download or buy anything.

Free to use and share. Tell us how it went: eddy.at.unwrap@gmail.com

PLAN A · CUBS, OLDER BEAVERS, BROWNIES · 60 MINUTES

Label Detectives

Aim: Cubs can find an ingredients list, spot kitchen and factory words, and sort foods into the Eatwell Guide groups.

Time	Activity	You need
0–5	**Opening: build a cake** In a circle, each Cub names one thing you'd put in a cake at home. Then read out the Sponge Cake label and ask who heard a word they didn't know.	Sponge Cake label card
5–15	**Label Relay** Teams line up. Pin the three label cards at the far end of the hall. Read a question; one Cub from each team runs, finds the answer on the labels, and runs back to tell their team. First correct answer wins a point.	Label cards, relay questions
15–20	**Stand up, sit down** Call out ingredients from the word list. Kitchen word: stand up. Factory word: sit down. Thumbs up or down works too.	Word list
20–30	**Kitchen or Factory?** In sixes, race to sort the word cards under the Kitchen and Factory headers. Talk about the tricky ones.	Kitchen or Factory? cards, one set per six
30–42	**Eatwell sort (badge link)** In sixes, place the food cards onto the five Eatwell Guide zones on the floor, plus 'outside the main guide'. Then ask: which group gives us most of our energy? Why is fruit and veg the biggest slice?	Eatwell cards; mark six zones with chalk or tape
42–52	**Label Lab challenge** In sixes, with two coloured pens: circle the kitchen words and underline the factory words on both yoghurts, then answer the questions. First six with everything right wins. Big reveal: Yoghurt B has no strawberries.	Label Lab sheet, one per six; two coloured pens
52–60	**Closing** Each Cub says one thing they'll look for on a label at home. Hand out the Label Hunt sheet for anyone who wants it.	Label Hunt sheet (optional, to take home)

Answers and word list

Label Relay questions

Question	Answer
What is there most of in the sponge cake?	Sugar (it's first)
Find an allergen in bold on the cake label.	Wheat, egg or milk
How many ingredients does Yoghurt A have?	3
How much strawberry is in Yoghurt A?	10%
Find a factory word on Yoghurt B.	e.g. stabiliser, flavourings
Which yoghurt has no strawberries at all?	B

Word list for stand up, sit down (and the Kitchen or Factory? cards)

Kitchen words (stand up)
flour, eggs, milk, butter, oats, tomatoes, honey, olive oil, salt, yeast, lemon juice, potatoes

Factory words (sit down)
emulsifier, glucose syrup, modified maize starch, flavouring, stabiliser, preservative, acidity regulator, humectant, glucose-fructose syrup, dextrose, maltodextrin, sweetener

Tricky ones are worth talking about rather than marking wrong. Baking powder is a kitchen word, but on a label it may appear as "raising agents (diphosphates, sodium carbonates)", which does the same job. A good test: could you buy it in a normal shop and cook with it at home?

Label Lab answers

Question	Yoghurt A	Yoghurt B
How many ingredients?	3	9
How much strawberry?	10%	None. The taste comes from flavourings and the pink from beetroot colour.
Kitchen words	yoghurt (milk), strawberries, sugar	yoghurt (milk), water, sugar
Factory words	none	glucose-fructose syrup, modified maize starch, stabiliser, flavourings, acidity regulator
One job	—	stabiliser or modified starch keeps it thick and smooth; flavourings give the strawberry taste; colour makes it pink

Label Cards

Print once and pin at the far end of the hall. All labels are made up.

SPONGE CAKE

INGREDIENTS:

Sugar, **Wheat** Flour (**Wheat** Flour, Calcium Carbonate, Iron, Niacin, Thiamin), Vegetable Oils (Rapeseed, Palm), Whole **Egg**, Glucose Syrup, Humectant (Glycerol), Dried Skimmed **Milk**, Emulsifiers (Mono- and Diglycerides of Fatty Acids), Raising Agents (Diphosphates, Sodium Carbonates), Modified Maize Starch, Salt, Flavouring, Preservative (Potassium Sorbate).

A · STRAWBERRY YOGHURT

INGREDIENTS:

Yoghurt (**Milk**), Strawberries (10%), Sugar.

B · STRAWBERRY FLAVOUR YOGHURT

INGREDIENTS:

Yoghurt (**Milk**), Water, Sugar, Glucose-Fructose Syrup, Modified Maize Starch, Stabiliser (Pectin), Flavourings, Acidity Regulator (Sodium Citrate), Colour (Beetroot Red).

PLAN A · ONE SET PER SIX

Kitchen or Factory?

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. Put the two big cards at the top of your space, then sort each word underneath.

KITCHEN	FACTORY

flour	emulsifier	eggs	glucose syrup
modified maize starch	milk	flavouring	butter
oats	stabiliser	tomatoes	preservative
acidity regulator	honey	humectant	olive oil
salt	glucose-fructose syrup	yeast	dextrose
maltodextrin	lemon juice	sweetener	potatoes

PLAN A · BADGE LINK · CUBS CHEF REQUIREMENT 3

Eatwell Sort

✂ Cut out one set per six. Sort onto the Eatwell Guide zones on the floor.

Fruit and vegetables	Starchy foods	Protein foods
Dairy and alternatives	Oils and spreads	Outside the main guide

Apple	**Carrots**	**Frozen peas**	**Banana**
Bread	**Pasta**	**Potatoes**	**Rice**
Baked beans	**Eggs**	**Chicken**	**Fish**
Milk	**Cheese**	**Plain yoghurt**	**Olive oil**
Biscuits	**Fizzy drink**	**Crisps**	**Strawberry flavour yoghurt**

Answers. Fruit and veg: apple, carrots, peas, banana. Starchy: bread, pasta, potatoes, rice. Protein: baked beans, eggs, chicken, fish. Dairy: milk, cheese, plain yoghurt. Oils and spreads: olive oil. Outside the main guide (foods and drinks high in fat, salt or sugar): biscuits, fizzy drink, crisps. **Strawberry flavour yoghurt** is a talking point: it's still dairy, even though it has no strawberries and more added ingredients. The Eatwell Guide and the label tell you different things.

PLAN A · ONE PER SIX · TWO COLOURED PENS

Label Lab Challenge

Names _____

A · Strawberry Yoghurt

INGREDIENTS:

Yoghurt (**Milk**), Strawberries (10%), Sugar.

B · Strawberry Flavour Yoghurt

INGREDIENTS:

Yoghurt (**Milk**), Water, Sugar, Glucose-Fructose Syrup, Modified Maize Starch, Stabiliser (Pectin), Flavourings, Acidity Regulator (Sodium Citrate), Colour (Beetroot Red).

Question	Yoghurt A	Yoghurt B
1. How many ingredients are there?		
2. Find the strawberries. How much is in it?		
3. On the labels above, **circle** the kitchen words and **underline** the factory words. How many factory words did you find?		

4. Pick one factory word from Yoghurt B. What job does it do?

Challenge: which yoghurt would be easier to make at home? Why?

PLAN A · TO TAKE HOME · OPTIONAL

Label Hunt

Name _____

For grown-ups: today your child learned how to read the ingredients list on food packets. If you have five minutes, look at a few packets in your kitchen together. This is just about noticing and counting. There are no right or wrong foods, and no need to change what anyone eats.

With a grown-up, look at the packets in your kitchen. Can you find...

Find...	What was it?	How many ingredients?
a food with just one ingredient		
a food with five or fewer ingredients		
the longest list in the cupboard		
the word "flavour" or "flavoured"		Which one?
an allergen in bold		Which one?

A word I found that I'd never seen before:

PLAN B · SCOUTS, GUIDES · 60–75 MINUTES

Behind the Label

Aim: Scouts can decode E numbers, judge how processed a food is, and check whether a claim on the front matches the back.

Time	Activity	You need
0–5	**Opening: two loaves** Read out both loaf labels. Patrols have one minute to agree: why does the packaged loaf need more ingredients?	Loaf labels
5–15	**E number code-breakers** Pin up the E number key, or copy it onto a flipchart. Call out E150, E202, E322, E440, E621, E951. Patrols race to write the job on a whiteboard. Point for each right answer.	E number key; whiteboards or paper
15–30	**Spectrum line-up** Mark four zones on the floor: 1 unprocessed, 2 cooking ingredients, 3 processed, 4 ultra-processed. Each patrol places all 16 food cards. Compare patrols; each must defend the card they argued about most.	Spectrum cards, one set per patrol; tape
30–45	**Claim Court** Each patrol is a jury. For each of the three products, they compare the front with the back and agree a verdict: true, true but selective, or rule-breaking. The patrol leader stands up and delivers each verdict with one reason.	Claim Court sheet, one per patrol
45–55	**Walking debate** Read the motion: 'Food packs should show how processed the food is.' Scouts stand on a line from agree to disagree and explain why. Anyone can move if they're persuaded.	Open floor space
55–60	**Closing** Each Scout names one claim they'll check next time they shop. Optional: set the Honest Pack design as a challenge for next week.	Honest Pack sheet (optional)

Answers

E number code-breakers

E150 colour (caramel) · E202 preservative · E322 emulsifier (lecithin; it's in the 300s, which shows why you check the job word) · E440 thickener or gelling agent (pectin) · E621 flavour enhancer (MSG) · E951 sweetener (aspartame).

Opening: two loaves

The packaged loaf has to stay soft and mould-free for days (preservative), is made fast in huge batches (emulsifier, flour treatment agent), and has to come out the same every time.

Spectrum line-up

Zone	Foods
1	apple, frozen peas, porridge oats, plain yoghurt
2	olive oil, salted butter, sugar
3	tinned chickpeas, cheddar, bakery sourdough, salted peanuts
4	cola, chicken nuggets, sliced white loaf
Arguable	Baked beans (modified cornflour and extracts push it towards 4; often classed as 4) and shop hummus (mostly kitchen ingredients plus a preservative; often 3, sometimes 4). Accept either with a reason.

Claim Court verdicts

- **Tropical Juice Drink:** true but selective. Only 10% fruit; it's mostly water and sugar, so legally it isn't a juice.
- **Fruity Oat Bar:** probably rule-breaking. Apple juice concentrate is added for sweetness, which the rules count as added sugar.
- **High Protein Pudding:** true but selective. Milk protein is added; the front doesn't mention the sweeteners and thickeners.

Walking debate and camp

There's no right answer in the debate. Reward reasons and listening. For camp, link it to menu planning (Chef badge requirement 1): before the shop, each patrol checks its menu's labels for the group's allergens and dietary needs.

Loaf Labels and E Number Key

Print once. Read the loaf labels out for the opening, and pin up the key for the code-breakers. All labels are made up.

LOAF 1 · HOMEMADE BREAD

INGREDIENTS:

Strong White **Wheat** Flour, Water, Yeast, Salt.

LOAF 2 · SLICED WHITE LOAF

INGREDIENTS:

Wheat Flour, Water, Yeast, Salt, **Soya** Flour, Preservative (Calcium Propionate), Emulsifier (E472e), Rapeseed Oil, Flour Treatment Agent (Ascorbic Acid).

E number key

E100s	Colours
E200s	Preservatives
E300s	Antioxidants and acidity regulators
E400s	Thickeners, stabilisers, emulsifiers and gelling agents
E500s	Acidity regulators and anti-caking agents
E600s	Flavour enhancers
E900s	Sweeteners, glazing agents and others

The hundreds are only a rough guide. On a label, always read the job word that comes before the E number.

PLAN B · ONE SET PER PATROL

Spectrum Sort

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. Place each food in zone 1, 2, 3 or 4 on the floor, using its ingredients.

1 · Unprocessed or minimally processed	2 · Cooking ingredients	3 · Processed	4 · Ultra-processed
Plain yoghurt Milk, Live Cultures	**Baked beans** Beans (51%), Tomatoes (34%), Water, Sugar, Spirit Vinegar, Modified Cornflour, Salt, Spice Extracts, Herb Extract	**Tinned chickpeas** Chickpeas, Water, Salt	**Bakery sourdough** **Wheat** Flour, Water, Salt
Sliced white loaf **Wheat** Flour, Water, Yeast, Salt, **Soya** Flour, Preservative (Calcium Propionate), Emulsifier (E472e), Rapeseed Oil, Flour Treatment Agent (Ascorbic Acid)	**Cola** Carbonated Water, Sugar, Colour (Caramel E150d), Acid (Phosphoric Acid), Flavourings, Caffeine	**Olive oil** Extra Virgin Olive Oil	**Salted butter** Butter (**Milk**), Salt
Chicken nuggets Chicken (45%), **Wheat** Flour, Water, Rapeseed Oil, Modified Maize Starch, Salt, Dextrose, Flavouring, Raising Agent (Sodium Carbonates)	**Cheddar cheese** **Milk**, Salt, Starter Cultures, Rennet	**Frozen peas** Peas	**Apple** Apple
Shop hummus Chickpeas (55%), Water, **Sesame** Seed Paste, Rapeseed Oil, Lemon Juice, Garlic, Salt, Preservative (Potassium Sorbate)	**Sugar** Sugar	**Porridge oats** Oats	**Salted peanuts** **Peanuts**, Sunflower Oil, Salt

PLAN B · ONE PER PATROL

Claim Court

Name _____

FRONT

Made with real fruit!

Tropical Juice Drink

BACK · INGREDIENTS:

Water, Sugar, Apple Juice from Concentrate (8%), Mango Purée (2%), Acid (Citric Acid), Flavourings, Colour (Beta-Carotene).

What does the front want you to think?	Verdict: true, true but selective, or rule-breaking? Why?

FRONT

No added sugar

Fruity Oat Bar

BACK · INGREDIENTS:

Oats (40%), Dates (25%), Apple Juice Concentrate (15%), Raisins (10%), Sunflower Oil, Cinnamon.

What does the front want you to think?	Verdict: true, true but selective, or rule-breaking? Why?

FRONT

High protein · 20 g per pot

High Protein Chocolate Pudding

BACK · INGREDIENTS:

Skimmed **Milk**, **Milk** Protein (12%), Water, Fat-Reduced Cocoa Powder (2%), Modified Maize Starch, Sweeteners (Sucralose, Acesulfame K), Thickeners (Carrageenan, Guar Gum), Flavouring, Salt.

What does the front want you to think?	Verdict: true, true but selective, or rule-breaking? Why?

Write one honest sentence you'd add to the front of one product:

_____

PLAN B · NEXT WEEK'S CHALLENGE · OPTIONAL

Design an Honest Pack

Name _____

Choose a product from Claim Court. Redesign the front so a shopper gets the full story in five seconds, and still wants to buy it.

FRONT OF PACK

MY PRODUCT

MY NEW SYMBOL AND WHAT IT MEANS

- [ ] No claim that isn't true
- [ ] The key % is easy to see
- [ ] Nothing important is hidden
- [ ] It still looks appealing

What was the hardest trade-off between honest and appealing?